

1. GAME OVERVIEW

- Objective: Build the highest-scoring animal farm by collecting animals, enclosing pastures, and constructing valuable buildings.
- Players / Time: 2 players; about 30 minutes.
- Game length: 8 rounds, with 3 worker placements per player each round.
- Win: Score animals, bonuses, buildings, and completed expansions. Highest total wins.

2. SETUP CHRONOLOGY

- Place the game board in the center.
- Give each player a farm board, forest at top and path at bottom, plus 3 workers and 9 borders.
- Lay out the 4 special buildings: Half-Timbered House, Open Stables, Shelter, and Storage Building.
- Set aside 4 farm expansions, 10 feeding troughs, and 4 stall tiles with stables on the reverse.
- Sort wood, stone, reed, sheep, pigs, cows, and horses into general supplies.
- Place the remaining 8 borders beside the Expand action space.
- Randomly choose the start player and give that player the start-player marker.
- Keep all supplies reachable. Animals must be housed immediately when gained.

3. STRUCTURE OF A ROUND

1 REFILL

Add goods to every action space with a refill arrow, even when goods remain. Add 1 border to Expand.

2 WORK

Starting player places 1 worker and resolves that unoccupied action. Alternate until all 6 workers are placed.

3 HOME

Return all workers from the game board to their owners.

4 BREED

For each animal type with at least 2 animals, gain exactly 1 newborn if it can be housed.

4. TYPICAL TABLE SETUP



CENTER: action board and shared supplies
SIDES: each player farm, workers, borders, and materials

1. KEY MECHANICS / RULES REFRESHER

- Worker actions: Place 1 worker on an unoccupied action space and perform the action immediately. You must be able to perform it.
- Animal placement: Animals gained must be housed immediately. Rearrange or release animals at any time; unhoused animals return to supply.
- Pastures: Must be fully enclosed. Each pasture contains only 1 animal type and holds 2 animals per farm space.
- Buildings: Cottage holds 1 animal; stall holds 3; stable holds 5. A building separates adjacent pasture areas.
- Feeding troughs: One per farm space. A trough doubles that pasture or building capacity; unenclosed, it holds exactly 1 animal.
- Borders: Fences cost 1 wood each. Walls: first 2 borders are free, then 2 stone per additional border.
- Expand: Take 1 farm expansion and all borders on Expand. Attach left or right. Borders are not placed by this action.
- Stalls / stables: Stall costs 3 stone + 1 reed. Upgrade a stall for 5 wood OR 5 stone; repeat if affordable.
- Breeding: Gain at most 1 sheep, pig, cow, and horse each round. Newborns need immediate capacity.

FREQUENTLY FORGOTTEN

- Refill-arrow spaces accumulate; spaces without arrows never refill.
- Each action space can be occupied only once per round.
- Animals of different types cannot share a pasture or animal-holding building.
- Built borders never return to your supply, even when a building replaces an edge.
- Take Start Player to claim or retain the marker for the next round.

2. SCORING SUMMARY

Animal	Base	Bonus begins after
Sheep	1 each	13th
Pigs	1 each	11th
Cows	1 each	10th
Horses	1 each	9th

- Animal points: 1 point per animal, plus 1 additional point for each animal beyond its type threshold.
- Scarcity penalty: -3 points for each animal type where you have 3 or fewer.
- Buildings: Add the printed point value of special buildings; the Half-Timbered House is worth 5 points.
- Farm expansions: Score 4 points for each expansion whose 3 spaces are all used.
- Tie: The player who was not the start player in round 1 wins.

4. END OF GAME

- After the breeding phase of round 8, the game ends.
- Total animal, bonus, building, and completed-expansion points; apply scarcity penalties.
- Highest score wins. Resolve a tie using the round-1 start-player rule.

3. STRATEGIC TIPS

GOOD HABITS

- Plan housing before taking animals; lost animals waste actions.
- Use troughs where doubling affects the most spaces or highest-capacity building.
- Keep building materials flexible for fences, stalls, and timely upgrades.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Do not mix animal types in one pasture or building.
- Do not count an incomplete enclosure as a pasture.
- Do not forget the border added to Expand each round.
- Do not take animals without immediate legal housing.

COMPETITIVE TIPS

- Watch which actions the opponent can deny with the next worker.
- Breed all four animal types when possible, but avoid the -3 scarcity penalties first.
- Expand only when the extra spaces can be fully used for the 4-point bonus.
- Track the bonus thresholds: horses pay bonuses earliest, sheep latest.
- Late-game buildings should add points, capacity, or both.